

ACTIVITY 10 — LEARNER WORKSHEET**Control Plan, A3 Summary, Handover, and Certification Readiness**

TYPE	DURATION	DMAIC PHASE
Core Activity	60 min	CONTROL

Name	
Date	

What you are doing

Hold the gain. Build a control plan that names the metric, the target, the monitoring frequency, the owner and the reaction plan — then tell the whole improvement story on a single A3 page and hand it over.

What you will produce: A control plan with a named owner and reaction plan on every row, a one-page A3 summary, a handover checklist and a personal certification readiness plan.

Tools and techniques: Control plan, SPC thinking, visual management, A3 report, handover

The scenario

Contoso Service Desk handles employee IT requests. Employees complain that tickets take too long to be assigned, that they must keep chasing for status, and that agents apply different definitions of what counts as "resolved". Handoffs between the front line and the specialist queues are unclear, and although ticket data exists it is inconsistent. You are supporting the improvement team as a Yellow Belt — you do not lead the project.

Two weeks of data have been collected: 400 tickets, of which 96 contained at least one defect, with 120 defects recorded in total across 6 defect opportunities per ticket. Mean assignment time is 55 minutes (median 46) against a 30-minute improvement goal. The CSV files in this activity's data/ folder are that extract.

Files in this activity folder**data/ — the mock data you analyse:**

- assignment-times.csv — 400 rows (date, ticket_id, assignment_time_min)

templates/ — the worksheets you complete:

- a3-summary.csv (a3_section, content)
- control-plan.csv (process_step, metric, target, owner, check_frequency, response_plan)
- handover-checklist.csv (handover_item, accepted_by, date, notes)

Open these in Excel, Google Sheets or LibreOffice Calc. Work on a copy so the originals stay clean for revision.

Re-plot data/assignment-times.csv in NovaSPC to show the post-improvement position.

Your steps

1. Create the control plan: metric, target, monitoring method, frequency, owner, reaction plan.
2. Define the visual management approach — board, dashboard or huddle — that keeps it visible.
3. Specify the reaction plan: exactly what happens when a metric falls outside target.
4. Write the A3 summary: background, current state, goal, analysis, countermeasures, results, follow-up.
5. Prepare the handover checklist so the process owner can sustain it without you.
6. Complete your personal certification readiness plan — which topics need most review.

Your working space

Complete every field. Keep this worksheet — it is your reference for applying the method at work.

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Step 5 — Prepare the handover checklist so the process owner can sustain it without you.

Step 6 — Complete your personal certification readiness plan — which topics need most review.

Answers to the discussion prompts

1. What happens, exactly, when the metric falls outside target — and who acts?

2. Could the process owner sustain this without you? What is missing?

3. Which topic do you most want to revisit after the course?

Reflect & discuss

What improvement at your workplace quietly decayed after the project ended?

What control would have held it?

Check your work

Every control plan row has a named owner and a reaction plan, and your A3 fits on one page.